Usability Report: Employee Onboarding

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Summary

Work Performed
This document presents the findings of the usability testing for Employee Onboarding at https://garage-boilerplate-basic-frontend-b14je7nrz-praise-the-fool.vercel.app/auth/signin

The purpose of performing usability testing is to help understand how the target users interact with the product, and the problems that arise from the process of using and navigating the webpage. To improve and refine our website, qualitative, moderate, remote testing was performed; to understand where and why users struggle and what needs to improve.

The testing was performed to answer the following questions:

- Can new employees sign in intuitively, either with email/password or Google?
- Are error states easily understandable?
- Does the tour effectively communicate everything that the employee needs to know?
- Do users understand what they need to complete?
- Can the users find the Assistant, via both the sidebar and Home page link?

Findings / Conclusion
From the tests, some findings were brought to attention:

- Overall layout and design felt standard for a company tool
- The participant could find and use the Assistant and review their tasks
- Participant had no major difficulty completing core flow
- **Areas to improve (Ranked by Severity)**
    1. Assistant gives no clear indication that it's processing a query
    2. Chat history disappears
    3. Task titles are not clickable links to actual tasks
    4. Tour is too long, and can't be reopened
    5. Size of the tour box is too small.
    6. Can't cancel an in-progress chatbot query
    7. Two separate links for the assistant felt "funny" (Sidebar and home page)
    8. Spacing and detail on Home and Profile pages need work
    9. Task titles are too long

Next Steps & Recommendations

1. Replace the spinner next to the send button with a chat bubble containing a spinner, clearly indicating that the Assistant is thinking
2. Allow chat history to persist across navigation of the current session.
3. Turn task titles into links to the task & shorten them
    - Needs to be discussed, as a task-pop up was discussed
4. Shorten the tour and add a way to relaunch it
5. Increase the size of the tour box, have a way to bring attention to it
6. Add a cancel option for in-progress queries
7. Reconsider duplicate assistant links
8. Tidy up home page spacing and expand profile page

Test Assessment

Objective
The objective of this test is to run target users through the webpage's features, to gather information on their understanding and intuition on using it.

Participants
Testing was conducted with an individual who meet at least one of the criterias:

- Has completed an onboarding process
- Has used an AI chat assistant or chatbot before
- Is comfortable using web apps on a desktop
- Currently work in office environment

Participant 01:
Wished to stay anonymous, currently an office worker who has also gone through an onboarding process in his company, whose company also has an AI assistant they use to help with tasks.

Materials
The testing was conducted by providing the user with a link to the vercel deployment of the application, with temporary login details provided to them to test with.

Procedure:

1. Participants were asked to access the webpage via the link given
2. Participants incrementally work through tasks as the facilitator asks
3. Facilitator observes each task and notes down participants behaviour
4. After all tasks are completed, the facilitator asks participant for their overall opinion and comments, and proceeds to ask questions from a pre-defined list.

Results
Usability testing was conducted remotely and moderated with one participant, who is an office worker that had been through company onboarding and had used an AI assistant at work. Participant shared their screen and completed tasks in order as directed by the facilitator. Facilitator noted down behaviour and thoughts, as well as feedback from the participant. Then, the post-task questions was asked.

In summary, the participant found the design to be standard and acceptable, but noted the lack of feedback while the Assistant was processing their query. The tour felt longer than necessary, he couldn't look back at his chat history, and suggested for the tasks to be clickable.

Test Session Checklist for the Facilitator

- Create a test account for the user to use
- Join a call with the user
- Introduce and explain the testing process
- Explain the setup and what the user needs to have prepared
- Request user to share their screen
- Have user complete tasks as defined, following facilitator requests
    - Facilitator takes notes as user navigates the webpage
- Ask user if they have any questions
- Ask user questions from the list

Tasks to perform

- Create a new account, through email or google (This will be deleted after the session)
- Wait for Facilitator's word to continue
- Attempt to log in with invalid details, then log in with the provided details.
- Participate in the tour
- When prompted, ask the assistant about your tasks
- Find out what tasks you need to complete
- If you're unsure about any tasks, try asking for help
- Once again, ask the assistant anything about your tasks
- Return to homepage and verify the tasks are the same

Post-Task Questions

1. Was the tour helpful with navigating the webpage?
2. Was anything confusing or unexpected?
3. Was there anything you expected to see but didn't?
4. Was there anything that was unclear, whether it be wording, labels, or buttons?
5. Did the page give you enough feedback about what was happening?
6. How did the layout and design feel?
7. Is there anything you would change? Was there anything you didn't like design wise?
8. Is there anything you would recommend?

Answers for Post-Task Questions

1. **Was the tour helpful with navigating the webpage?**
    - "It was (the tour) unnecessarily long, it feels like there's more things than there actually is"
    - “I didn’t realize it (tour box) was in the corner until you told me.. It was tiny and a bit annoying to look at…. It blocks my query when it prompted me to ask a question”
2. **Was anything confusing or unexpected?**
    - "The lack of a (clear) loading spinner indicating that it's thinking... I didn't know it (the assistant) was thinking"
    - Chat history disappearing
    - Tasks should be links leading to the actual tasks
3. **Was there anything you expected to see but didn’t?**
    - A clear loading chat bubble
    - Being able to cancel the chatbot's query
4. **Was there anything that was unclear, whether it be wording, labels, or buttons?**
    - It would be good to be able to pull up the tour again
    - "It's a bit funny that there's two links leading to the assistant"
5. **Did the page give you enough feedback about what was happening?**
    - The loading spinner being next to the send button makes it unclear that the chatbot is thinking, suggested to be a chat bubble with a spinner
6. **How did the layout and design feel?**
    - "If it's a company thing, that's pretty standard"
7. **Is there anything you would change? Was there anything you didn’t like design wise?**
    - Some of the spacing with text in the home page feels weird, the profile page needs better spacing and more details
8. **Is there anything you would recommend?**
    - "Making these (task titles) into links that lead to the actual task"
    - Titles could be shorter